bases in the Caribbean, the purchase of the Virgin Islands and the exercise of influence in Central America from time to time which has been determined by United States vital interest of protection of Panama Canal and the American continent. In most cases, however, imperialist policies have been motivated by economic interests. Sometimes altruism has been emphasized as a motivating factor and in most cases English colonialism was justified by some as "shouldering the white man's burden". France also justified its colonizing moves as a sort of civilizing mission. Sometimes missionary zeal worked as a factor for colonialism. Religious missionaries were active in Africa, India and China. In England, Protestant missionary societies were a vocal impetus to British imperialism. Although strong economic forces have worked behind much of the growth of modern imperialism, it would be illogical if other factors are ignored. "No simple explanation, no dogmatic theory, will suffice"[5] as Imperialism is, in all its manifestations, the result of the interplay of complex forces that may have psychological, sociological, religious, political, military, intellectual, and personal-rule roots.

Professor Joseph Schumpeter suggested that imperialism is "the objectless disposition on the part of a state to unlimited forcible expansion". He further stated, "It would never have been evolved by the 'inner logic' of capitalism itself", but must be regarded "not only historically, but also sociologically, as a heritage of the autocratic state".[6]

A systematic economic explanation of the urge of the states to expand was given by Marx. When "Capital grows in one place to a huge mass in a single hand because it has in another place been lost by many" a stage of monopoly capitalism is reached. Each capitalist tries to increase profits by reducing the production costs, especially by saving the wages, and competes to win larger sales of product, which results in search for raw materials and new markets, and hence outward expansion. Hobson attributed this expansion as the "economic taproot of imperialism". Lenin[7] in his seminal work *Imperialism: The Highest Stage of Capitalism*, viewed imperialism as a stage of capitalist development and not merely as one possible set